

IDEA x JPMorgan Preliminary Behavioral Research

Research Focus

Since the rise of generative AI in 2022, it has been a cornerstone of professional productivity, readily integrating into employee's daily lives. However, the fear of replacement, personal objections, and unclear implementation of AI can cause friction with the tool, and quickly turn into resistance. The difference between access and acceptance of AI lies in the behavioral motivations of an individual.

Our research will focus on this gap, how it is realized in the workplace, and its possible solutions.

Behavioral Barriers - Psychological:

- **Black Box**: Employees may struggle to trust AI as its decision making mechanisms are internal, hidden, and cannot be fully understood
- **Lack of Autonomy**: As humans desire control over their environments, introducing AI can be perceived as a threat to one's agency
- **Fear of Replacement**: When employees measure their capabilities against AI, they perceive it as a competitor, rather than a partner
- **Poor Output Quality**: AI may create more work through extensive revision and cleanup work

The AI Adoption Gap:

The AI Adoption Gap is the disconnect between the way leaders and employees perceive AI's role in an organization. While leaders may see AI from a strategic, efficiency forward lens, employees see AI from a task lens as it interacts with their specific tasks. This can create differences in measurement of AI progress, and miscommunication of AI's usefulness within the organization.

Behavioral Barriers - Interpersonal:

- **Team Dynamics**: Employees not as experienced with AI may worry about the quality of work and become dissenters within the group
- **Introduction of AI**: AI should be introduced with an understanding of a company's friction points, otherwise it cannot fully apply to employees' work
- **Generic Training**: Employees in different departments and positions need guidance on how to optimize AI for their specific roles, general training is not as impactful

How this informs our project: This research grounds our project in a human-centered approach as we use a mix of qualitative interviews and quantitative surveys to recognize how JPMorgan employees interact with AI, and how we can tailor our workshop to be the most impactful to them.